

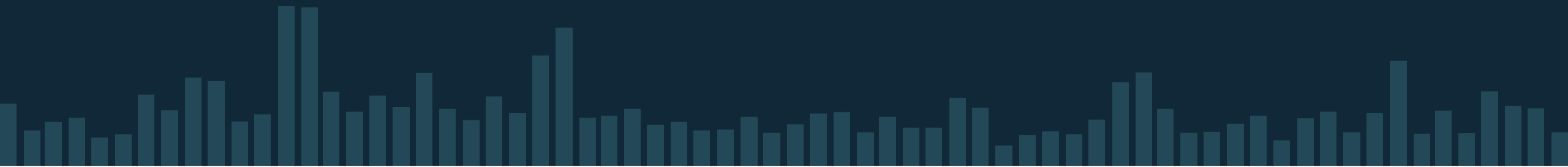
Reading the economy through the News: AI-assisted narrative and sentiment analysis of media text

| *How visible is the central bank when inflation fills the news?*

Luka Sikić

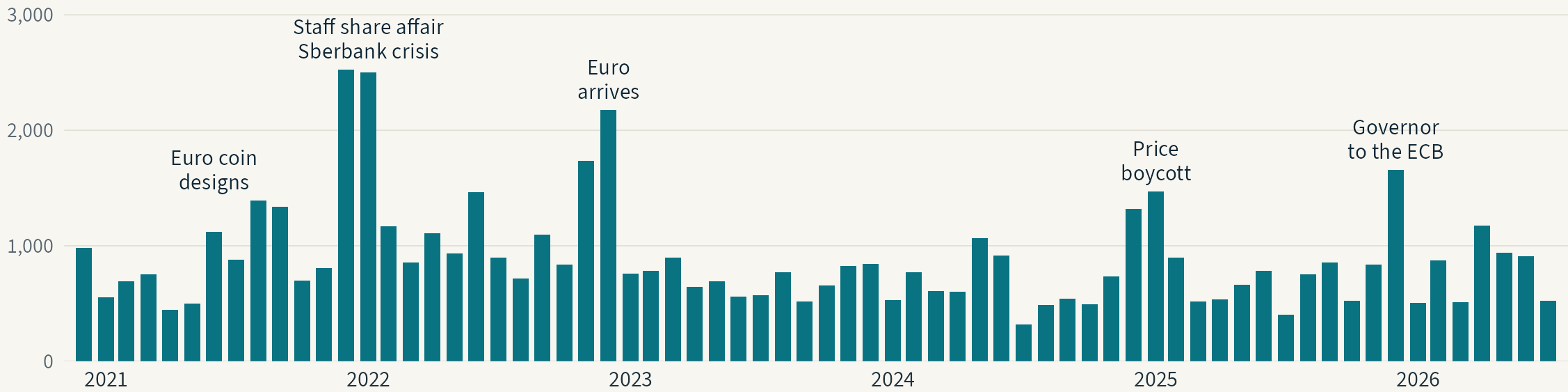
Hrvatsko katoličko sveučilište

Based on the working paper by Petra Palić and Luka Sikić, version of 28 September 2026



HNB is in the Croatian news every day

29 items a day name HNB
2,403 sources · January 2021 to August 2026



Euro and prices lead the headlines around HNB

Share of headlines that mention each topic, among items naming HNB

Euro and kuna		22%	about 1 in 5
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Prices and inflation		12%	about 1 in 8
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The governor		9%	about 1 in 11
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Loans and interest		9%	about 1 in 11
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In 2022 HNB had more inflation stories but a smaller slice

	2021		2022	
Inflation stories with HNB	8,419	→	17,278	twice as many
All inflation stories	40,639	→	129,932	three times as many
HNB's slice	21%	→	13%	smaller

More stories, smaller slice.

A headline story counts more than a passing mention

OUR ARTICLE · ENGLISH SUMMARY

HNB expects average inflation of 7.7% in 2023

Index.hr · 30 June 2023

0.97 HNB at the centre

COMPARISON · ENGLISH SUMMARY

Minister demands a return to earlier prices

Index.hr · 5 January 2023

0.07 One passing mention

Score from 0 to 1,
four questions

In the headline?

Named early?

Named often?

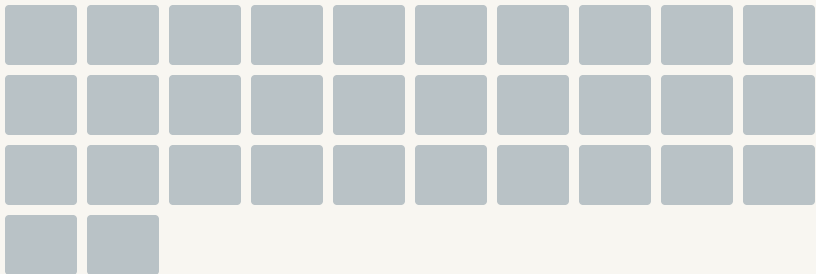
Acts or is quoted?

More inflation news shrinks HNB’s share

HNB items
score × reach



All inflation news
reach



Larger share

Smaller share

HNB SHARE

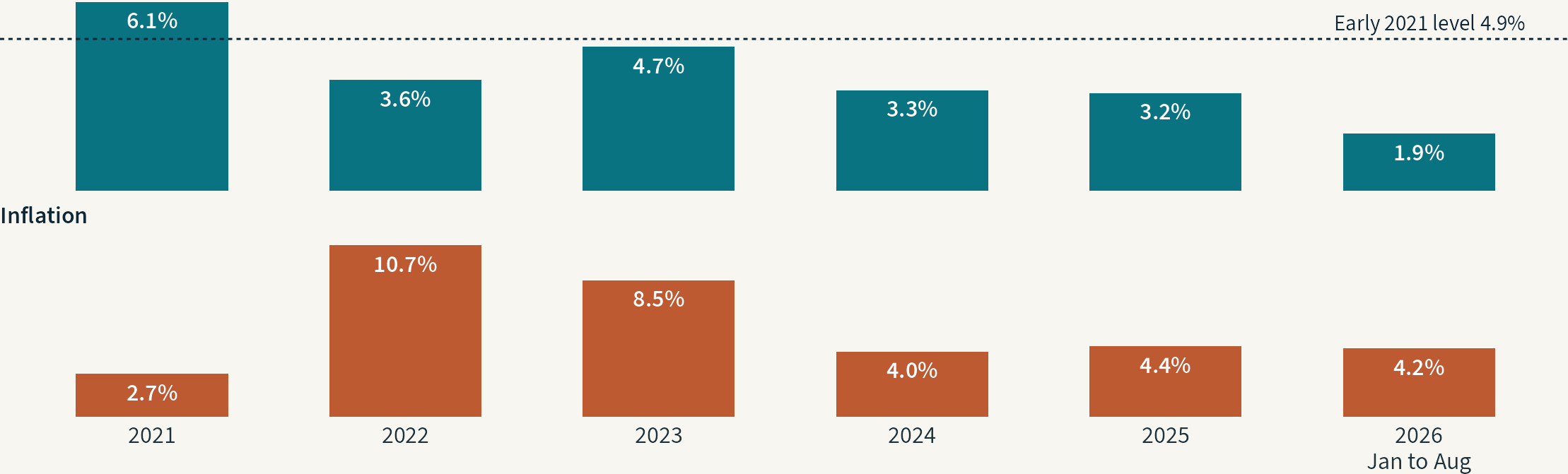
teal pile ÷ grey pile

ATTENTION GAP

early 2021 share, about 5%, minus today's share

HNB’s share fell in the inflation surge and stayed low

HNB share of inflation news



Our June 2023 article is one of 13,365 HNB inflation items that year.

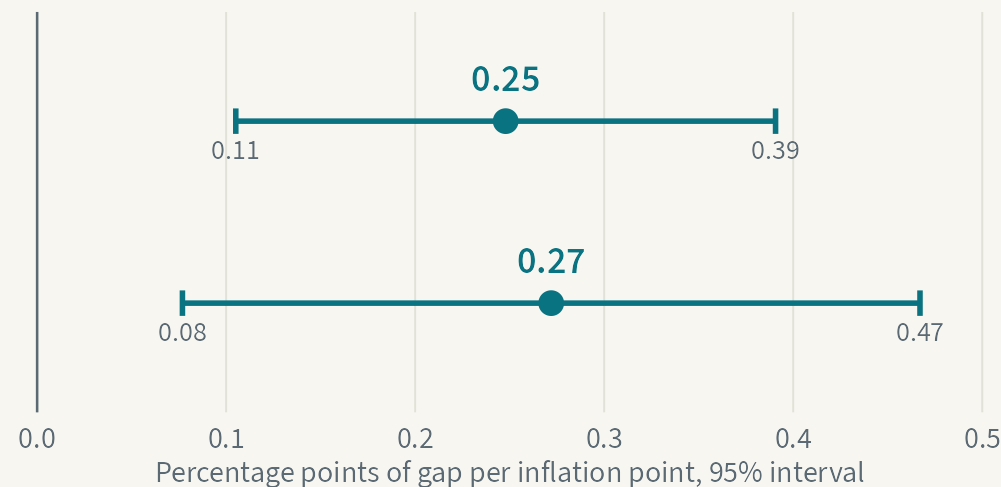
Higher inflation goes with a wider attention gap

0.25

percentage points wider gap
per point of inflation
for the same amount of HNB coverage

Weekly model
295 weeks

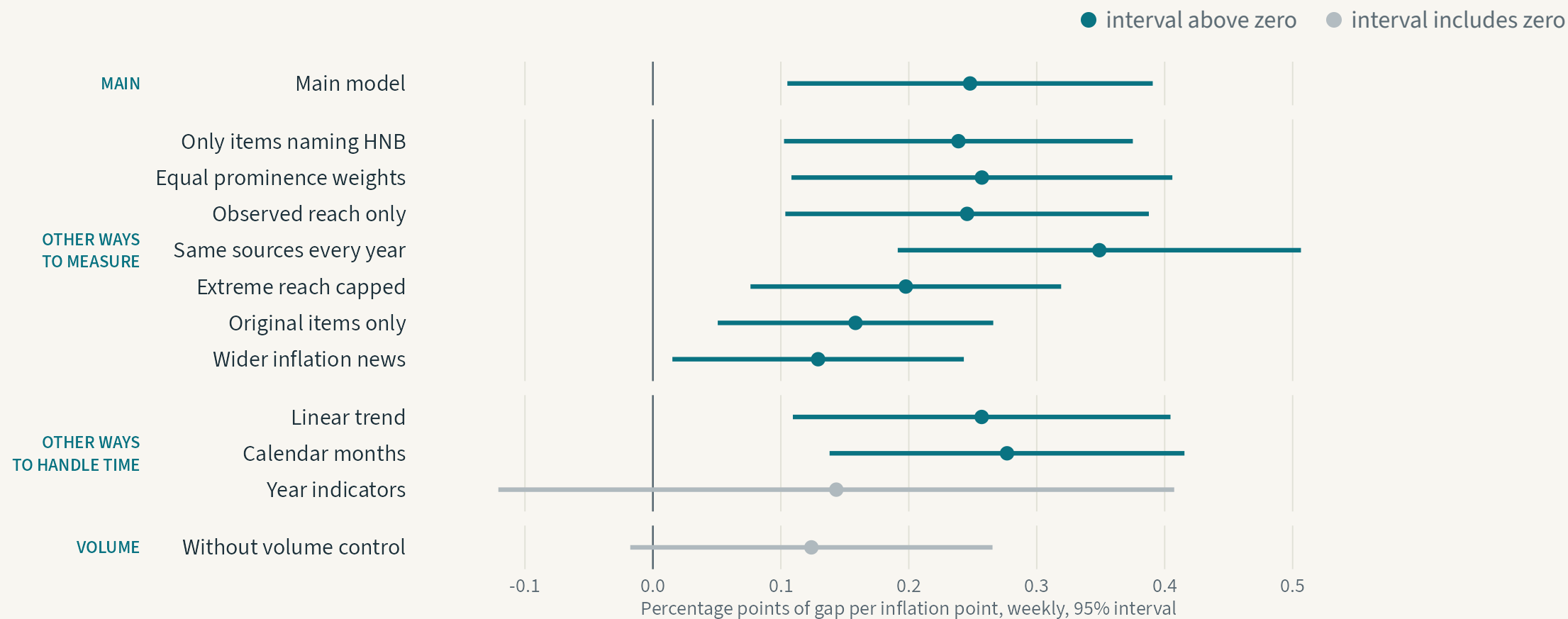
Monthly model
67 months



2% → 10% inflation ≈ gap about 2 points wider

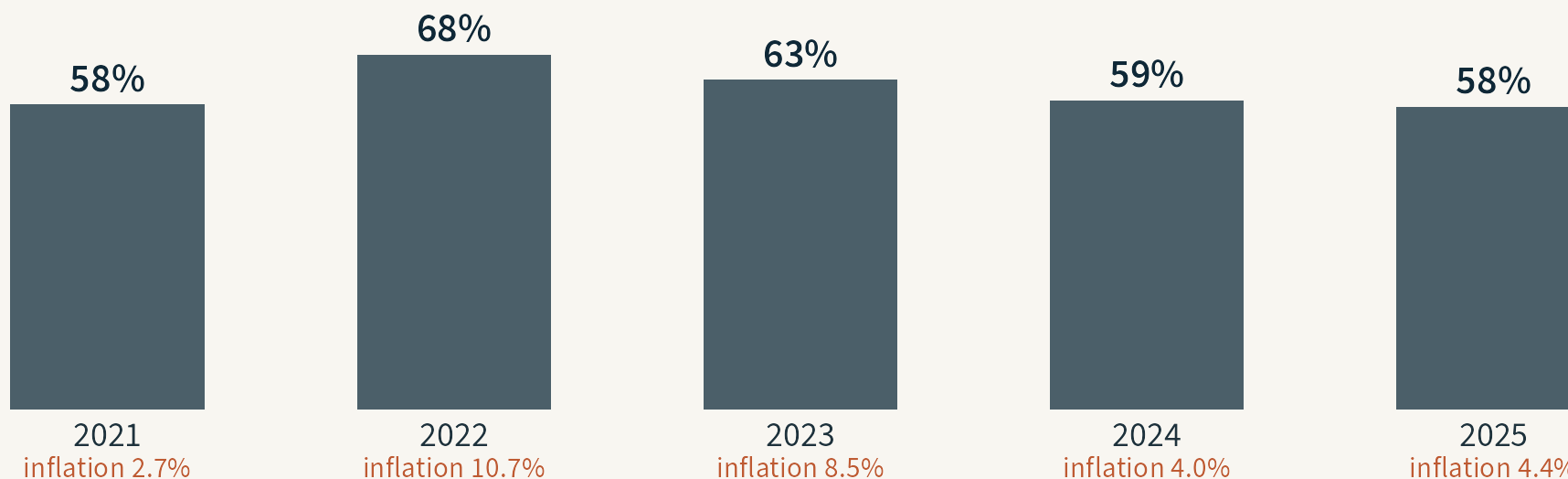
The starting share
was about 5%

Robust across measures, sensitive to year controls



Most HNB inflation news is labelled negative

Share of HNB inflation items with a negative tone label



CAVEAT The labels come from the data vendor and have not yet been checked against human readers

AI can check what our simple rules miss

PLANNED • NOT YET DONE

1

FIND

Which bank? Is it even news?

2

WEIGH

How central is HNB in the story?

3

TONE

Is the tone label right?

4

STORY

What explanation does the article give?

THE TEST

400 articles coded by two people, then the AI is checked against them

Our article shows what was said, not what was understood

OUR ARTICLE · ENGLISH SUMMARY

HNB expects average inflation of
7.7% in 2023

Index.hr · 30 June 2023 · score 0.97

- ✓ Published
 - ✓ HNB at the centre
-
- ? Read
 - ? Understood
 - ? Changed expectations

Three things to remember

- 1 HNB is in the news every day, but its slice of inflation news shrank when inflation rose, and has not come back
- 2 For the same HNB coverage, one point more inflation goes with a gap 0.25 points wider
- 3 AI can sharpen every step, if we check it against people

Next step: read the story behind the headline.